

鴨鴨六爻 (YaYa LiuYao)

Features and differentiation — supporting notes for App Store Review Guideline 4.3(b)

Category Traditional divination tool / study aid **Platform** iOS (the Android build has the same features)

Architecture Fully offline, no backend server

1. What we understand this guideline is for

Guideline 4.3(b) names fortune telling as a saturated category, and the review team sees a lot of apps that are the same thing with a different name and a different icon. We think that rule is reasonable, and we understand why an app with "LiuYao" in its name lands in that bucket first.

So this document does not argue that our app is better than other apps. That is not what the guideline asks. It asks whether there is real original work in the app. We have tried to answer that with things a reviewer can open and check.

What the app is: 鴨鴨六爻 (YaYa LiuYao) is not an app that gives you a paragraph of fortune when you tap a button. It is a charting tool and a study aid for **LiuYao**, a specific method of Chinese divination with several centuries of written literature behind it. The app **produces no predictions and no interpretations**, and it has no daily-horoscope style generated content. The user reads the chart and draws their own conclusion. Our job is to compute the chart correctly, make the classical texts readable, and give the user a way to practise.

It is built for two kinds of user, not just one

For beginners, it is a textbook that asks questions back. The hard part of learning this subject is not getting a result, it is understanding how the result was derived. Ordinary charting apps hand over the answer, so a beginner never gets past taking the app's word for it. We do the opposite. Practice mode blanks out the chart and asks the user to work the values out and fill them in, then marks each cell (feature 1). Every worked example in the classical texts is redrawn as a full chart so a reader can follow the original reasoning (feature 2). Forty-five illustrated teaching cards cover the ground from the beginning (feature 5). Together those three are a path from knowing nothing to reading a chart unaided, not a help file bolted on the side.

For working practitioners, it is a case record system they can build up over years. In practice a reading leaves more behind than the chart: the spoken reasoning at the time, a photo of the page you were looking at, a video of an explanation. Those are what actually help months later when you go back over a case. Every record in this app can carry **voice memos, images and video links** (feature 3), and the tagging, client grouping and full-text search (feature 9) mean that several hundred cases are still findable.

The part we care about most is **cross-referencing between methods**. A practitioner looking at one person will often want that person's birth chart, their divination cases and their hour-based readings side by side. In this app a LiuYao case can be linked directly to the same person's records in 鴨鴨八字 (YaYa Bazi) and 鴨鴨六壬 (YaYa LiuRen), and you can jump straight across and back (feature 4). As far as we know, **not many apps in this category do both cross-app record linking and multimedia case records**. Neither of those falls out of the charting algorithm. They come from having thought about how this work is actually done.

So: this app is not a charting engine. The engine is where it starts. On top of it there is a practice and marking system, a library of classical texts redrawn chart by chart, and a record-keeping workflow that reaches across three apps. A template app can produce the first of those. It cannot produce the other three.

2. Feature list

Ordered by how relevant we think each one is to this rejection. The numbers are used again in the figures below.

#	Feature	What it is, and what is original about it	Originality
1	Practice mode with automatic marking	Chart cells are blanked out and the user fills them in from scratch. Each cell is marked green, red or amber and the score is kept. This is a test system, not another way of displaying a result.	Built by us
2	Classical texts with every case redrawn	298 worked cases from <i>Zeng Shan Bu Yi</i> and 194 from <i>Bu Shi Zheng Zong</i> , all included with modern-language notes, and every case redrawn as a complete chart from the original text. Not a plain-text ebook.	Built by us
3	Multimedia case records	Up to 20 voice memos, images and video links per case. Videos are stored as a reference plus a thumbnail, never copied; playback is handed to the system photo library, so the app needs no photo library read permission.	Built by us
4	Cross-app record linking	A case can be linked to the same person's records in YaYa Bazi and YaYa LiuRen and opened directly. Custom protocol with version negotiation and signature checks in both directions. Nothing goes through a server.	Built by us
5	Teaching section	45 illustrated cards in ordered chapters, from what LiuYao is through to reading a chart.	Built by us

#	Feature	What it is, and what is original about it	Originality
6	Six casting methods, incl. 3D dice	Manual, coins, dice, numbers, coin wheel, three wheels. The dice roll in a real SceneKit physics scene: two eight-sided dice and one six-sided, shake or press to build power, and they collide and settle on their own.	Built by us
7	64 two-sided hexagram cards	All 64 hexagrams, front and back, 128 illustrations drawn for this app. Flip and zoom, with the classical text and a modern reading.	Built by us
8	Case sharing codes	A whole chart compressed into a short alphanumeric string that another device restores exactly. Custom bit-level format, bit-compatible between iOS and Android.	Built by us
9	Tags, grouping and full-text search	Colour tags (50 overall, 3 per case), grouping by client name with an alphabetical index, and full-text search across client, question and notes with hits highlighted.	Deep integration
10	Notes written next to the chart	The note field and the chart stay on screen together. No full-screen editor covering the chart while you type.	Deep integration
11	Interactive chart marks	The chart is not a static table. Positions can be marked to keep track of relationships already worked through.	Deep integration
12	Perpetual calendar with solar terms	Sexagenary calendar, solar term progress, and working a date back from the four pillars. Shares the same calendar code as the charting engine.	Common in category

3. The four that matter most

1. Practice mode with automatic marking Built by us

Most apps in this category are one-way calculators: tap once, read the result. This one asks the user to do the work. Practice mode blanks the chart and the user has to derive the relations, the six spirits, the governing and responding lines, the hidden lines and the void branches from the date and the hexagram, and type them in. Pressing *Check* marks every cell — green for correct, red for wrong, amber for left blank — and writes the score to a history. Single-chart practice and the three-chart random test share the same question-setting and answer-key logic. Leaving halfway records nothing; only pressing Check writes a result.

That needs more than a charting engine. Something has to decide which cells this particular chart should test, what the correct answer is for each one, and which cells are correctly left empty and must not count against the user. It is an assessment system, and a charting template cannot produce it.



Figure 1. Filling in and marking: green correct, red wrong, amber left blank

2. Classical texts with every case redrawn Built by us

This is where most of the work went. *Zeng Shan Bu Yi*, all four volumes and 136 chapters, contains **298 worked cases**; *Bu Shi Zheng Zong* contains **194**. Both are included in full with modern-language notes. The part that took the time is that **every one of those cases has been redrawn as a complete chart** from the original text, with the stems and branches, the relations, the six spirits, the governing and responding lines, the hidden lines and the void branches all filled in.

The original text only says "obtained hexagram X changing to hexagram Y". A reader who cannot build that chart themselves cannot follow the reasoning that comes next. Turning 298 cases into charts a reader can hold against the text is a different order of work from pasting old text into a file. The source texts are in the public domain, but the edition in this app has also been collated: variant characters normalised, punctuation redone, and errors in the printed originals corrected.

The figure displays three screenshots of a mobile application interface, illustrating the process of redrawing classical cases into modern charts.

Left Screenshot (4:54): Shows the app's main menu with options like "卜筮正宗" (Divination Canon), "增刪卜易" (Increase/Decrease Divination), and "易經64卦" (I Ching 64 Hexagrams). The "卜筮正宗" section is highlighted with a red box.

Middle Screenshot (4:55): Displays the "卜筮正宗" section, specifically the "第六問" (Sixth Question). The text is presented in a modern, readable format. The "問曰" (Question) and "答曰" (Answer) sections are highlighted with red boxes. The "問曰" section asks: "伏吟之凶有輕重分別乎？" (Is the severity of the凶 (misfortune) in伏吟 (伏吟) different?). The "答曰" section provides a detailed explanation of the凶 (misfortune) in伏吟 (伏吟) and its severity.

Right Screenshot (4:55): Displays the "卜筮正宗" section, specifically the "占兵到，一家當避何處" (Divination: When the army arrives, where should one family avoid?). The text is presented in a modern, readable format. The "占" (Divination) section is highlighted with a red box, showing a table of results. The table lists various hexagrams and their corresponding meanings, such as "玄武" (Black Tortoise) for "妻財" (Wife/Wealth) and "白虎" (White Tiger) for "官鬼" (Official/Devil).

Figure 2. Original text, modern reading and the redrawn chart side by side

3. Multimedia case records

Built by us

In practice a reading is rarely just the chart. There is what you said at the time, the page you photographed, the recording of an explanation you were working from. Each record in this app can hold **voice memos, images and video links**, up to 20 of each, alongside the written notes on the same card.

The video handling is worth describing. We **store a reference and one thumbnail, and never copy the video into the app**. We also store a device identifier so that a record restored on a new phone does not end up pointing at a different file. Playback is handed to the system photo library, which means **the app does not declare photo library read permission at all**. The point of doing it that way is to offer the feature while keeping both the permissions we ask for and the storage we take to a minimum. A template app does not make that trade.



Figure 3. Voice memos, video links and images on one record card

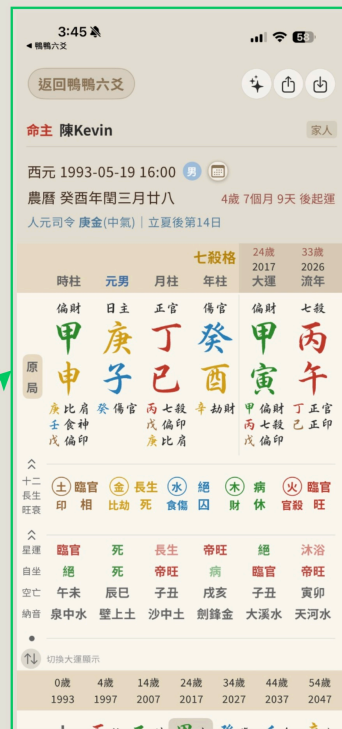
4. Cross-app record linking Built by us

Practitioners routinely want to look at one person's birth chart, divination cases and hour-based readings together. In this app a LiuYao case can be linked to that person's records in 鴨鴨八字 (**YaYa Bazi**) and 鴨鴨六壬 (**YaYa LiuRen**), opened directly, and returned from.

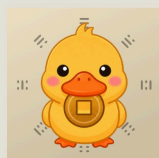
Underneath it is a protocol we wrote: version negotiation, **signature certificate checks in both directions** (the app being called verifies the caller's signature before it hands anything back), and single-use short-lived tickets. No server is involved and no data leaves the device. It also answers a question that section 7 comes back to. The three apps are complementary tools, and if they were re-skins of each other there would be nothing to link.



鴨鴨八字
app



Jump to
Linked
Record



鴨鴨六爻
app



鴨鴨六壬
app



Figure 4. Jumping from a LiuYao case to the same person's Bazi chart and LiuRen reading

4. The rest

5. Teaching section Built by us

45 cards in ordered chapters with illustrations drawn for the app, starting from what LiuYao is and ending at reading a chart. The aim is that someone with no background can make sense of what the app produces.



Figure 5. Teaching cards and illustrations

6. Six casting methods and 3D dice Built by us

The coin wheel and the three wheels are the coin and dice methods with a different interface; the probability distribution is the same as the original method. All six only produce six line values, and every one of them then goes through the same charting engine. That constraint is deliberate: however the user casts, the chart is computed identically.



Figure 6. Six casting methods and the 3D dice

7. 64 two-sided hexagram cards Built by us

All 64 hexagrams with a front and a back, 128 illustrations in total, drawn for this app. They flip and zoom, and carry the classical judgement and line texts with a modern reading, plus the eight-palace attribution.



Figure 7. Tapping the hexagram name opens the card viewer (the viewer itself is a dark screen in the app)

8. Case sharing codes Built by us

A compact binary encoding with a check character, bit-compatible between iOS and Android: the same code has to decode to the same chart on both platforms.



Figure 8. Generating a code, sending it, and restoring the same chart

9. Tags, grouping and full-text search Deep integration

Colour tags (50 overall, 3 per case), grouping by client name with an alphabetical index, and full-text search over client, question and notes with hits highlighted. For anyone who accumulates several hundred cases this is what decides whether the app stays usable.



Figure 9. Colour tags, client grouping and full-text search

10. Notes written next to the chart Deep integration

The note field sits under the chart and both stay on screen. Interpreting a chart means checking relations and writing down a judgement at the same time, and covering the chart with a full-screen editor interrupts exactly that.



Figure 10. The chart stays visible while notes are typed

11. Interactive chart marks Deep integration

The chart is not a static table. Positions can be marked while working through a complicated case, to keep track of which relationships have already been dealt with.

盤面

伏神	六親	六獸	六親	本卦	裝卦	變卦	六親
		玄武	父母	—	戌		
		白虎	兄弟	—	申	空	
		螣蛇	官鬼	—	午	○	
		勾陳	兄弟	—	申	空	
寅	妻財	朱雀	官鬼	×	午	亥	子孫
子	子孫	青龍	父母	—	辰		

標記

靜態旺衰

辰月相日沖 午月建日墓 申月死日辰 戌月相日辰

四爻本卦「午」

記號 2/3 · 點上面的記號可移除

✕ ○ ① ○ ① △

☆ 🌙 ⬆ ⬇

清除此格記號

盤面

伏神	六親	六獸	六親	本卦	裝卦	變卦	六親
		玄武	父母	—	戌	×××	
		白虎	兄弟	—	申	空	
		螣蛇	官鬼	—	午	○	
		勾陳	兄弟	—	申	空	
寅	妻財	朱雀	官鬼	×	午	亥	子孫
子	子孫	青龍	父母	—	辰		

標記

按住爻地支可做標記

清除標記

靜態旺衰

辰月相日沖 午月建日墓 申月死日辰 戌月相日辰

Figure 11. Marks on the chart

12. Perpetual calendar with solar terms Common in category

Sexagenary calendar, solar term progress, and working a possible date back from the four pillars. This one is not unusual in the category and we list it for completeness; the difference is that it shares its calendar code with the charting engine and the records.

4:50

53

鴨鴨六爻

萬年曆



2026 年 丙午年



09 月 丙申~丁酉月



周日

周一

周二

周三

周四

周五

周六

丙子 30 十八	丁丑 31 十九	戊寅 1 二十	己卯 2 廿一	庚辰 3 廿二	辛巳 4 廿三	壬午 5 廿四
癸未 6 廿五	甲申 7 白露	乙酉 8 廿七	丙戌 9 廿八	丁亥 10 廿九	戊子 11 初一	己丑 12 初二
庚寅 13 初三	辛卯 14 初四	壬辰 15 初五	癸巳 16 初六	甲午 17 初七	乙未 18 初八	丙申 19 初九
丁酉 20 初十	戊戌 21 十一	己亥 22 十二	庚子 23 秋分	辛丑 24 十四	壬寅 25 十五	癸卯 26 十六
甲辰 27 十七	乙巳 28 十八	丙午 29 十九	丁未 30 二十	戊申 1 廿一	己酉 2 廿二	庚戌 3 廿三
辛亥 4 廿四	壬子 5 廿五	癸丑 6 廿六	甲寅 7 廿七	乙卯 8 寒露	丙辰 9 廿九	丁巳 10 初一

丙午年 丙申月 戊寅日

今日

西元 2026 年 9 月 1 日

民國 115 年 9 月 1 日

農曆 丙午年七月二十

月將 巳

戊寅日



起卦



記錄



練習



萬年曆



教學



古書



設定

Figure 12. Perpetual calendar and solar terms

5. The engineering underneath

A charting engine we wrote ourselves

The full Jing Fang eight-palace derivation — the primary and changed hexagrams, palace and element, governing and responding lines, the stems and branches assigned to each line, the six relations, the six spirits, void branches, hidden lines, changing-line relationships and the auxiliary star tables — is implemented from scratch as pure functions. No off-the-shelf divination SDK and no third-party service. The calendar side covers sexagenary dates, the lunar calendar, solar terms and month determination.

Records store the minimum, everything else is recomputed

Each record keeps only what cannot be derived again: the time of casting, the six line values, the four pillars, and whatever the user wrote. Everything else on the chart is recomputed by the engine when the record is opened. That is what makes editing one line and having the whole chart follow correct by construction, rather than a matter of keeping cached fields in step.

Offline, and we do not send user data anywhere

All computation, all classical text, all records and all media stay on the device. The app **does not send cases, client names or questions to any server**. The only network feature is fetching app announcements. The "AI prompt" feature does **not** call a model and return an answer: it formats the chart into structured text that the user **copies themselves** into whichever AI they prefer. We deliberately do not send it for them, which means the user's question never passes through us.

6. About our other two apps

We also publish 鴨鴨八字 (YaYa Bazi) and 鴨鴨六壬 (YaYa LiuRen). If part of the concern here is whether the three are the same app published three times: they are three different systems of divination, in the way that chess, go and xiangqi are three different games. They share the visual vocabulary of a board and nothing about how they are played.

App	System	Core computation (no overlap between them)
鴨鴨六爻 (YaYa LiuYao)	LiuYao divination	Six line values give a hexagram; derives eight-palace attribution, stem and branch assignment, six relations, governing and responding lines, hidden and changing lines
鴨鴨八字 (YaYa Bazi)	Bazi astrology	A birth moment gives four pillars; derives hidden stems, ten gods, the ruling element of the month, chart structure, and decade and annual luck cycles

App	System	Core computation (no overlap between them)
鴨鴨六壬 (YaYa LiuRen)	Da LiuRen	The month general placed on the hour gives the heaven and earth plates; derives the four lessons, three transmissions, nine patterns and the twelve generals

The inputs differ, the algorithms differ, the chart layouts differ, the terminology differs and the classical texts differ. Each has its own engine and its own tests. What they share is the brand look and some base components — calendar conversion, record storage, export — which is what any team maintaining three products does.

7. What we are planning next

We treat this as a product we will keep working on rather than something to publish once and leave. If it can stay on the store, the direction we are currently weighing up is a small community layer inside the app:

- **Sharing and discussing cases.** The sharing code (feature 8) already compresses a whole chart into a short string that another device can restore. The next step would be letting users post a case so that other learners can look at the same chart and argue about how to read it. For someone learning alone, seeing how another person reads the same chart is often worth more than any textbook.
- **Matching people with paid consultations.** Letting users who want a reading find practitioners willing to give one, as a small marketplace.

Both are **still being evaluated and neither has been started**. We are not offering them as grounds for this review — every feature described above is already in the shipping binary and can be checked there. We mention them to show that there is a long-term plan here.

We are also aware that user-generated content and paid matching bring other rules into play. If we do go ahead, we will build them accordingly, including reporting and moderation for user content (Guideline 1.2) and in-app purchase where it is required for digital content (Guideline 3.1). Until then the app stays as it is: fully offline, no user-generated content, no social features.

8. What we can provide

- A screen recording showing the practice marking, the dice physics and the redrawn classical cases in use.
- A TestFlight build, so the review team can take as long as they need with it.
- If any of the above does not behave as described on your test device, please tell us which feature and which step and we will look into it straight away. Everything in this document can be exercised in the shipping binary.

We are not arguing that this category should be looked at any less carefully. We are arguing that this app is doing something different inside it: it produces no fortunes and no conclusions, and instead turns a method with several centuries of literature behind it into something a person can learn, practise, and check against the original sources. Thank you for taking the time to read this.

鴨鴨六爻 (YaYa LiuYao) — Features and differentiation. The features described here are the same in the iOS and Android builds.